seriously was a maverick Jewish officier, Colonel Emile Mayer. We may thus surmise that he overcame any native antisemitism during the most momentous period of his life, only to relapse into it when he grew older, with a special twist: as the champion of French national independance, he was becoming increasingly anti-American, and he tended to confuse Jews, or Israel for that matter, with "Anglo-Saxon imperialism.

For all that, the current revival of antisemitism in France and Europe is not simply a resurgence of the enduring Christian heresy of Marcionism. What makes it particularly virulent is that it has fused with what one could call "Islamic Marcionism." Admittedly, Marcion as such never exerted any direct influence on Islamic doctrine or culture. But quasi-Marcionite views developed at a very early stage in the Islamic world, whether in the *Hadith* (the Prophet's reported deeds and sayings) or the *Sira* and *Maghazi* literature (the systematic relation of the prophet's life and of Islam's early victories). According to these sources, the Jews were utterly perverse enemies of Allah, Muhammad, and the Islamic *Umma*—in fact, devilish creatures that had to be destroyed. There is much evidence that just as Christian Marcionism was an attempt to sever Christianity from its Jewish roots, Islamic quasi-Marcionism was originally an attempt to erase from Islam its own Jewish roots, so apparent in the Quran, in many Judaizing Hadith (the *Israililyat*), and in Islamic ritual, law, or terminology.[7]

Christian and Islamic antisemitism have met and interbred since the 19th century: it is apparently more rewarding for the two communities to hate the Jewish Devil together than to dwell on irreconciliable differences between Cross and Crescent, West and East, Europe and Asia, colonial expansion and Jihad. Antisemitism was an important factor in the global alliance between fascist powers and Islam before and during World War Two, whether in the Arab world (with figures like Haj Amin al-Husseini in Palestine or Rashid Ali in Iraq) or in the Balkans and in the German-occupied USSR—where Muslim Waffen-SS units were easily set up. Nazi and fascist antisemitic agitation and legislation was an inspiration for Muslim antisemitic pogroms in Algeria, Turkey, Iraq, Morocco, Libya, Egypt; and Muslim antisemitic legislation in Egypt and Turkey. Muslim antisemitism was even used by Vichy France from 1940 to 1944, either in colonial North Africa before the American landings in 1942, or in France proper. Jacques Doriot's French People's Party and Marcel Déat's National People's Rally, the two major pro-Nazi parties in occupied France, had large chapters drawn from the North African Muslim immigrant community; the infamous "French Gestapo" operating from Rue Lauriston in Paris had so many Muslim recruits as to be known as an Arab Gestapo."[8]

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